Day 106 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in Indian Economy & TN Dev. Admin. (9): PLFS Annual Report 2025

READING MATERIAL

Covers the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) Annual Report 2025 — India's first comprehensive labour report based on a full calendar year.

Q: What is the PLFS Annual Report 2025, and what makes it distinctive?

A: The Periodic Labour Force Survey's Annual Report for 2025 — brought out by the National Statistical Office (NSO) as the FIRST comprehensive PLFS report based on a calendar year (January-December 2025), rather than the survey's earlier July-June reporting cycle.

Q: When was PLFS launched, and by which body?

A: Launched in 2017 by the National Statistical Office (NSO), to estimate key employment and unemployment indicators.

Q: What was India's total employment figure, per this report (persons aged 15+)?

A: 56.2 crore persons.

Q: What was the Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) for persons aged 15+, and the female LFPR specifically?

A: Overall LFPR: 56.1%. Female LFPR: 35.3% — both reflecting rising participation and improving inclusion.

Q: How did youth (15-29 years) unemployment change from 2024 to 2025?

A: Declined from 10.3% (2024) to 9.9% (2025) — a clean year-over-year improvement.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The PLFS Annual Report 2025 is distinctive because it is the first comprehensive PLFS report based on:

A. A quarterly cycle

B. A calendar year (Jan-Dec) ✓

C. A 5-year cycle

D. Only urban areas

Explanation: A calendar year (January-December 2025). [medium, web-research]

2. PLFS was launched in 2017 by which body?

A. RBI

B. NITI Aayog

C. National Statistical Office (NSO) ✓

D. Ministry of Finance

Explanation: National Statistical Office (NSO). [medium, web-research]

3. Per the PLFS Annual Report 2025, India's total employment (persons aged 15+) was approximately:

A. 46.2 crore

B. 51.2 crore

C. 56.2 crore ✓

D. 61.2 crore

Explanation: 56.2 crore. [hard, web-research]

4. Per the PLFS Annual Report 2025, the female Labour Force Participation Rate (LFPR) was approximately:

A. 25.3%

B. 30.3%

C. 35.3% ✓

D. 40.3%

Explanation: 35.3%. [hard, web-research]

5. Youth (15-29 years) unemployment declined from 10.3% (2024) to what in 2025?

A. 8.9%

B. 9.4%

C. 9.9% ✓

D. 10.1%

Explanation: 9.9%. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Time and Work

READING MATERIAL

Time and Work is the last of the 10 named Aptitude skills — after this, Part B moves to its Reasoning unit. Real exam evidence shows heavy use of 'trap' questions designed to look like they need complex math but actually resolve via a simple ratio.

Q: Method — inverse proportion (more workers, less time): 12 men complete a work in 36 days. In how many days will 18 men finish the same work?

A: Men × Days = constant (total work). $12 \times 36 = 18 \times x \rightarrow x = 432/18 = 24$ days. More workers means proportionally fewer days.

Q: Method — sequential combined work: A, B, C can complete a job alone in 8, 12, 16 days respectively. A and C work together for 2 days, then C leaves and B joins A. In how many more days do A and B finish?

A: Work rates: A=1/8, B=1/12, C=1/16 per day. In 2 days, A+C complete $2\times(1/8+1/16)=2\times(3/16)=3/8$ of the work. Remaining = 5/8. A+B's combined rate = $1/8+1/12 = 5/24$ per day. Days needed = $(5/8)\div(5/24) = (5/8)\times(24/5) = 3$ days.

Q: Method — wages split by share of work done: A can do a job in 10 days, B in 15 days. They work together for 5 days, then C finishes the remaining work in 2 days. Total payment for the whole job is Rs.5,000 — how should it be split?

A: Pay is split in proportion to how much of the TOTAL work each person actually did, not how many days they worked. In 5 days, A completes 5/10=1/2 of the job, B completes 5/15=1/3; together that's 5/6, leaving 1/6 for C to finish. Split of Rs.5,000 by work share: A gets 1/2×5000=Rs.2,500; B gets 1/3×5000≈Rs.1,667; C gets 1/6×5000≈Rs.833. The key insight is the split follows WORK DONE, not days worked — C worked fewer days than B but did a comparable or different share depending on the rates, and pay tracks output, not time.

Q: Method — pairwise combined rates → solve for all three together: A+B finish a job in 12 days, B+C in 15 days, C+A in 20 days. In how many days can A, B, C finish it together?

A: Add all three pairwise rates: $(A+B)+(B+C)+(C+A) = 1/12+1/15+1/20 = 2(A+B+C)$'s rate. LCM=60: $5/60+4/60+3/60=12/60=1/5$. So $2\times$(A+B+C rate)=1/5 → (A+B+C) rate=1/10 → together they finish in 10 days.

Q: Trap question: If 9 spiders make 9 webs in 9 days, how many days does 1 spider take to make 1 web?

A: 9 days — NOT 1 day. Each spider makes 1 web in 9 days regardless of how many spiders work in parallel (they're not collaborating on the SAME web). This tests whether you recognize the rate-per-individual stays fixed, the classic trap being to assume the answer scales down to 1.

Q: Method — pipes filling and draining together: Two pipes fill a tank in 30 and 40 minutes separately; a third pipe drains it in 24 minutes. With all three open, how long to fill the tank?

A: Combined rate = $1/30+1/40-1/24$ (subtract the draining pipe's rate). LCM=120: $4/120+3/120-5/120 = 2/120 = 1/60$. So the tank fills in 60 minutes.

Q: Method — provisions lasting fewer days with more people (inverse proportion again): 1,000 soldiers have 70 days of provisions. If 400 more soldiers join, how long will provisions last?

A: People × Days = constant (total provisions). $1000\times70 = 1400\times x \rightarrow x = 70000/1400 = 50$ days.

Q: Method — find the second worker's solo time from a combined time and the first worker's solo time: A and B together finish a job in 16 days; A alone takes 48 days. How long does B alone take?

A: B's rate = (A+B)'s rate – A's rate = $1/16 - 1/48 = 3/48-1/48 = 2/48 = 1/24$. So B alone takes 24 days.

Q: Trap question: If 5 persons complete 5 projects in 5 days, how long do 50 persons take to complete 50 projects?

A: Still 5 days — NOT 50 days. The ratio of people to projects stays the same (1:1), so the per-project time doesn't change; 50 people working on 50 projects is just 10 independent copies of the original 5-person/5-project scenario happening in parallel.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. 15 men complete a work in 24 days. In how many days will 20 men finish the same work?

A. 16 days

B. 18 days ✓

C. 20 days

D. 30 days

Explanation: $15\times24=20\times x \rightarrow x=360/20=18$ days. [easy, authored]

2. A and B together can finish a job in 18 days; A alone takes 45 days. How long does B alone take?

A. 24 days

B. 27 days

C. 30 days ✓

D. 36 days

Explanation: B's rate = 1/18−1/45 = 5/90−2/90=3/90=1/30. B alone takes 30 days. [medium, authored]

3. If 7 workers build 7 walls in 7 days, how many days does 1 worker take to build 1 wall?

A. 1 day

B. 7 days ✓

C. 14 days

D. 49 days

Explanation: 7 days — each worker's individual rate is unaffected by how many work in parallel on separate walls. [medium, authored]

4. Two pipes fill a tank in 12 and 15 minutes separately; a third pipe drains it in 20 minutes. With all three open, how long to fill the tank?

A. 8 minutes

B. 10 minutes ✓

C. 12 minutes

D. 15 minutes

Explanation: Rate = 1/12+1/15−1/20. LCM=60: 5/60+4/60−3/60=6/60=1/10. Time = 10 minutes. [medium, authored]

5. 800 soldiers have provisions for 60 days. If 200 more soldiers join, how long will the provisions last?

A. 40 days

B. 45 days

C. 48 days ✓

D. 50 days

Explanation: 800×60=1000×x → x=48000/1000=48 days. [easy, authored]

6. A, B, and C can do a job alone in 24, 30, and 40 days respectively. Working together, how long will they take?

A. 8 days

B. 10 days ✓

C. 12 days

D. 15 days

Explanation: Combined rate = 1/24+1/30+1/40. LCM=120: 5/120+4/120+3/120=12/120=1/10. Together they take 10 days. [medium, authored]

7. If 8 people complete 8 tasks in 8 days, how long do 40 people take to complete 40 tasks?

A. 8 days ✓

B. 20 days

C. 40 days

D. 320 days

Explanation: Still 8 days — the people-to-task ratio (1:1) is unchanged, so per-task time is unchanged. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "The Stick-Together Families" — Edgar Albert Guest

READING MATERIAL

Another Edgar Albert Guest poem (his third in this syllabus), arguing that joint/close-knit families are happier than those who scatter in search of external pleasures. Real exam evidence confirms specific quoted lines directly.

Q: What is the poem's central theme?

A: Joint/close-knit ('stick-together') families are happier than those who scatter — there is nothing greater than a happy family gathered together, as opposed to people who wander seeking happiness through 'strange friends' and external pleasures, only to find emptiness.

Q: Real exam: "Come you back unto the fireside and be comrade with your kin." Which poem is this line from?

A: "The Stick-Together Families" — confirmed via a real TNPSC question (2024) that tested this exact quoted line against three other poem-title options.

Q: Real exam: "But the gladdest sort of people, when the busy day is done, are the brothers and the sisters who together share their fun." Who wrote this?

A: Edgar Albert Guest, in "The Stick-Together Families" — confirmed via a real TNPSC question testing this exact line's authorship.

Q: What is the poem's structure (stanzas, lines, rhyme scheme)?

A: Four stanzas of six lines each, rhyme scheme AABBCC (rhyming couplets).

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "The stick-together families are happier by far."

A: Alliteration — repeated initial sounds across the phrase.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "A circle at the fireside that no power but death can break."

A: Metaphor — the family bond is directly described as an unbreakable 'circle', without 'like/as'.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "The finest of conventions ever held beneath the sun."

A: Hyperbole — an exaggerated, absolute claim ('ever', 'beneath the sun') praising the family gathering.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Each goes searching after pleasure in his own selected way."

A: Personification — 'pleasure' is treated as something actively pursued/sought, with people personified as hunters chasing it down individually.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "That the strange friend is the true friend."

A: Irony — directly contradicts the poem's own argument (that close family, not strangers, brings true happiness), used ironically to describe the mistaken belief some people hold.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Come you back unto the fireside and be comrade with your kin" is a line from:

A. Life

B. The Stick-Together Families ✓

C. The Poison Tree

D. The River

Explanation: Confirmed via a real 2024 TNPSC question. [hard, question-bank-2024]

2. "But the gladdest sort of people... are the brothers and the sisters who together share their fun" was written by:

A. D.H. Lawrence

B. William Wordsworth

C. Edgar Albert Guest ✓

D. Mary Botham Howitt

Explanation: Edgar Albert Guest, confirmed via a real 2024 TNPSC question. [hard, question-bank-2024]

3. What is the rhyme scheme of "The Stick-Together Families"?

A. ABAB

B. AABBCC ✓

C. ABCB

D. No fixed rhyme

Explanation: AABBCC, rhyming couplets across 6-line stanzas. [hard, web-research]

4. "A circle at the fireside that no power but death can break" uses which figure of speech?

A. Simile

B. Personification

C. Metaphor ✓

D. Hyperbole

Explanation: Metaphor — the family bond described directly as an unbreakable circle. [medium, web-research]

5. "The finest of conventions ever held beneath the sun" is an example of:

A. Simile

B. Metaphor

C. Hyperbole ✓

D. Alliteration

Explanation: Hyperbole — an exaggerated, absolute claim. [medium, web-research]

6. "That the strange friend is the true friend" is an example of:

A. Irony ✓

B. Simile

C. Metaphor

D. Hyperbole

Explanation: Irony — contradicts the poem's own central argument. [medium, web-research]